

The lecture was very inspiring, Randy Pausch is a captivating speaker. His message is one that should be heard by all. I can't even imagine how difficult it would be to know you only had a few months to live and still have so much enthusiasm for life. It became more clear throughout his lecture that if you have lived your life by getting as much as you can out of every experience, treat people well, work to help others, and expand your mind that you will live a fulfilling and rich life. I think that would make it easier to know your life won't be ending without feeling fulfilled.

I found myself thinking deeper on what he said while talking about football because of the lesson on mindsets. Randy relayed what one of his coaches told him which was- when people stop helping you it means they have given up. That really stuck with me. Reaching a point where people think you can't be helped any further would be devastating especially if it was in something you were passionate about. Nobody is beyond help. It reminds me of something I learned in philosophy to the effect of- if someone is willing to learn then they can be taught, but if someone is not willing then they will learn nothing. If you are willing and you can find someone to support you and to teach/coach you then you will grow and will get better.

I have always believed that the best way to learn is to never stop being curious, and where is the best place to source curiosity? In childhood wonder. When we are kids we don't limit ourselves to what is "reasonable" or "practical" or even to what is real, we dream, we question, we make things up, we imagine beyond what we know. Randy spoke about how the best way to succeed is to never let go of your childhood wonder and I agree. Only in that way can we grow and advance ourselves when we are not limiting ourselves to the restrictions of societal convention.